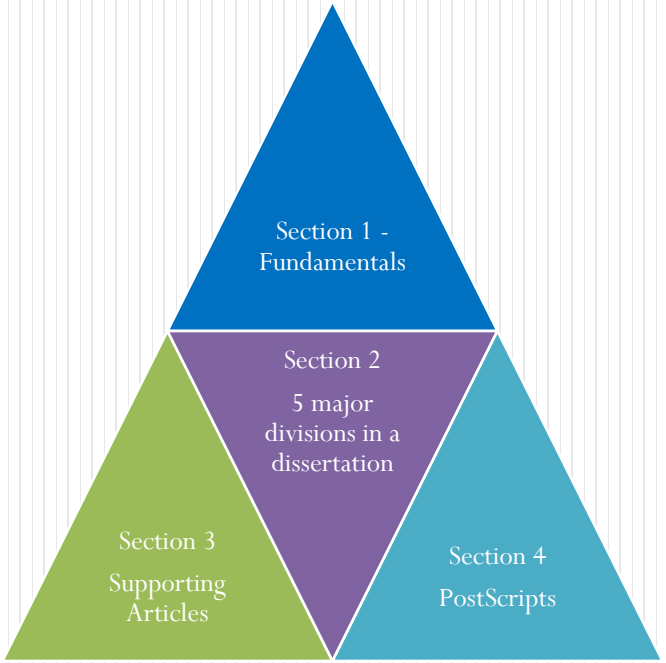
Project Management



To fail to plan is to plan to fail.

Robert Wubbolding

Project Management

- Part of the dissertation is to demonstrate to do research and write up a substantive academic work
- Who cares?
  - Supervisor? Mother? Spouse?
  - Whose responsibility is it?
- You need to take responsibility of the process from beginning to end.
- You need to manage the project effectively by breaking it up in smaller pieces.

Create timelines

- Advantages of timelines:
  - Break a large and intimidating work down into small, clearly achievable tasks
  - Let you correctly order the tasks that need doing
  - Let you apply the right amount of effort to each task
  - Ensure that no necessary tasks are forgotten
  - Let you create deadlines for various tasks
  - Let you stop worrying about tasks that you don't need to do
  - Let you see at any where you are
  - Force you to work consistently
  - Let you choose the amount of time that you can comfortably use for your dissertation
  - Let you adapt efficiently when circumstances dictate that you do.

Sample general dissertation timeline

- Think about your own strengths and weaknesses – if you struggle with writing, allow more time for writing.
- Break the different tasks down to small sub-tasks with a time allocated to each task.
- Tasks may overlap. Rather than stopping when you wait for feedback from your supervisor, do something else.
- When writing up, make page estimates; chapter estimates; sections, subsections.
- Plan backwards. From the estimated date of completion.

Sample general dissertation timeline

You need to make a judgment on how much time you can spend on your dissertation per week. Be realistic: You have a life outside your dissertation and you need to give yourself time for it. Completing a dissertation a little earlier that you might otherwise have is not worth an alienated family, a strained work environment, or a nervous breakdown.

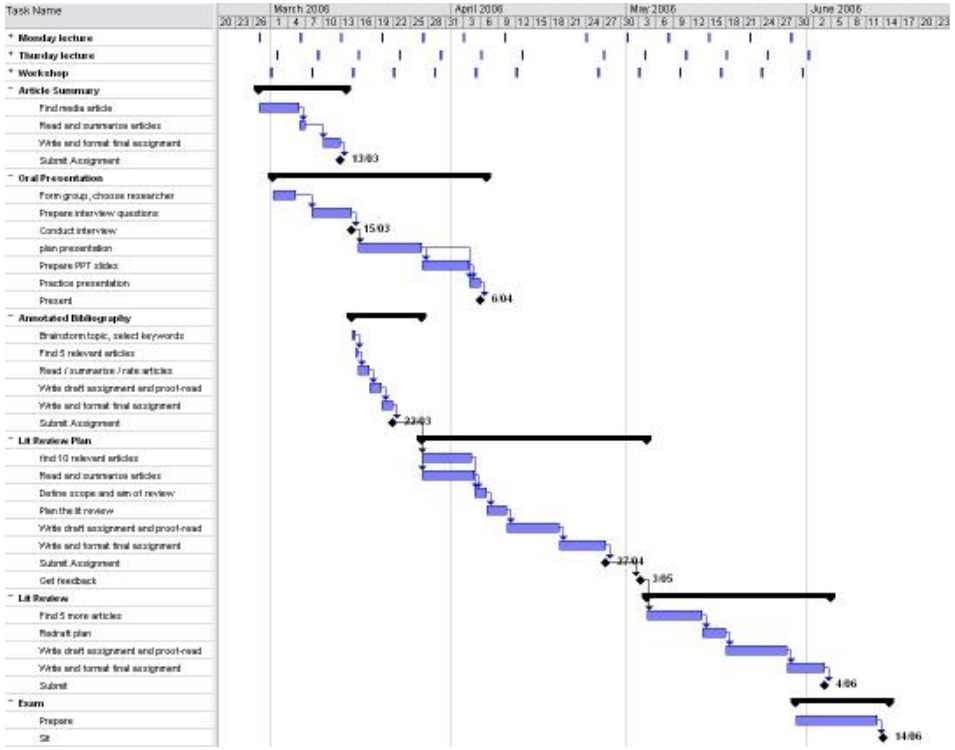
- Thesis is not finished when the last word is written. Leave time for editing, incorporating supervisor's feedback, binding etc.
- Commit to your timelines!
- Be aware that a great form of procrastination is engaging in non-essential activities (sometimes related to the dissertation).
- Be careful of derailing yourself.
- Don't create a sub-research direction!
- Be careful of over-indulging in e-mails.
- When are you on your most productive?
- Be careful of the Internet surfing trap.

Think …

- What are your biggest reason for NOT committing to periods of research?
- What is your time-line? Time-line should go into research proposal : last item ..

Gannt Charts

- Graphical representation of start and finish dates.



What are the key activities that you will be involved in for your thesis?

- In your groups – discuss what are all the activities involved in the writing of a thesis (your following year).

Join at menti.com | use code 2861 0427

Mentimeter

List the activities that you still need to complete for your thesis:

fast
bold
creative
inspiration
leader
focus
transpiration

AV

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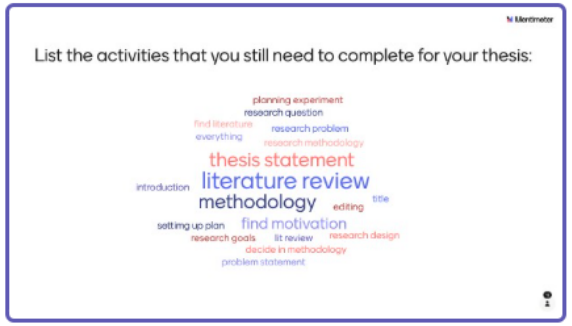
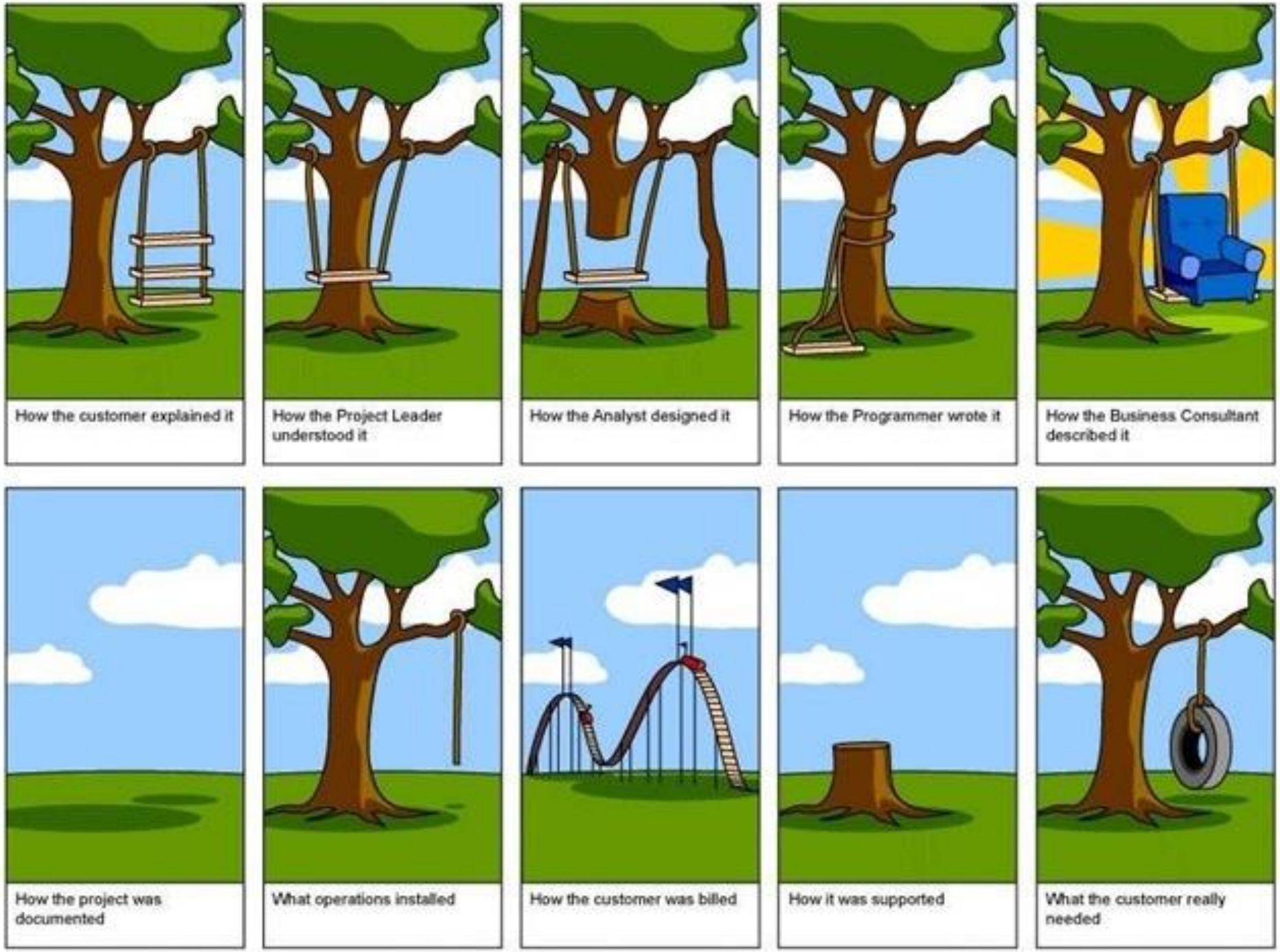


Create a simple PERT Chart

- Create a Gannt Chart for the activities listed;
- Use an electronic tool e.g. Excel, venngage.com


How the customer explained it
How the Project Leader understood it
How the Analyst designed it
How the Programmer wrote it
How the Business Consultant described it
How the project was documented
What operations installed
How the customer was billed
How it was supported
What the customer really needed